

Upsilon Andromedae
4 Suns

Delta Andromedae
45 Suns

Alpheratz
115 Suns

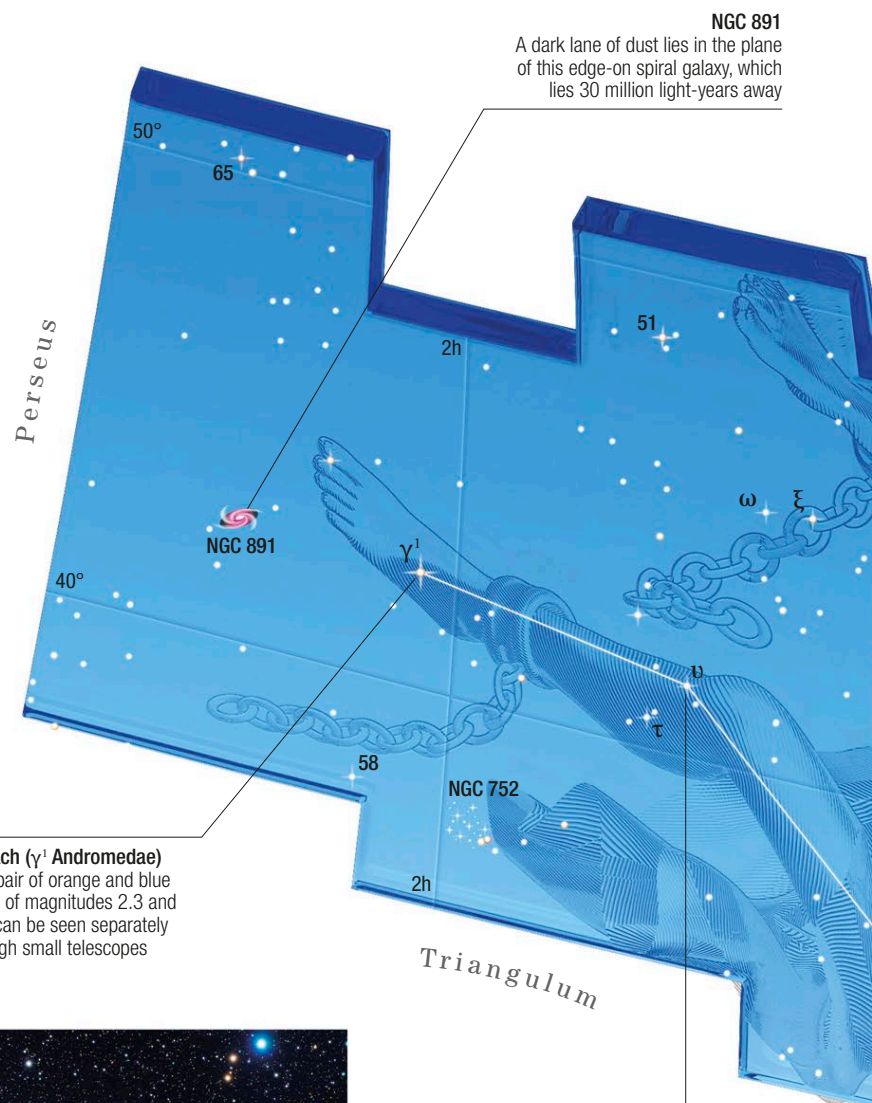
ANDROMEDA

THE CAPTIVE PRINCESS

ANDROMEDA LIES NEXT TO ONE CORNER OF THE SQUARE OF PEGASUS. THIS CONSTELLATION CONTAINS THE NEAREST LARGE GALAXY TO THE MILKY WAY, A VAST SPIRAL KNOWN AS M31.

Andromeda was a mythical princess, the daughter of Queen Cassiopeia and King Cepheus. In one of the best known Greek myths, the gods ordered Andromeda to be sacrificed to the sea monster Cetus to atone for her mother's vanity, but she was rescued from the monster's jaws by the hero Perseus. Andromeda and her rescuer are commemorated in the sky by adjoining constellations.

The most important object in this constellation is the Andromeda Galaxy, also known as M31, a huge spiral of stars similar to our own Milky Way but even larger. The Andromeda Galaxy is just visible to the unaided eye on clear, dark nights near the star Nu Andromedae. It is easy to see with binoculars or a small telescope, appearing as an elongated smudge. Lying 2.5 million light-years away, M31 is the most distant object visible to the naked eye.



NGC 891
A dark lane of dust lies in the plane of this edge-on spiral galaxy, which lies 30 million light-years away

Almach (γ^1 Andromedae)
This pair of orange and blue stars, of magnitudes 2.3 and 4.8, can be seen separately through small telescopes

Upsilon (ν) Andromedae
This was the first star found to be orbited by more than one planet. Four planets are now known in its system



△ NGC 7662
Popularly known as the Blue Snowball, this 9th-magnitude planetary nebula appears as an elliptical blue-green patch through small telescopes. Photographs reveal the central star.



◁ M31
The great spiral M31 is tilted at an angle to us, so that it appears elliptical. Two smaller companion galaxies are also visible in this picture—M110 below it and M32 on its upper edge.

▷ Star distances

The nearest of Andromeda's pattern stars is Upsilon (ν) Andromedae at 44 light-years away. The brightest star, Alpheraz (α Andromedae) is just over twice that distance, at 97 light-years away. The most distant pattern star is Phi, which is about 700 light-years from Earth.

